StackAid assists funding of dependencies for open source projects

There are a number of platforms available to assist and finance open source projects. But how can the project maintainers and contributors pay for the dependencies that go along with them?

In a single project, there could be hundreds of dependencies. Therefore, in order to begin fundraising, there are several challenging tasks at hand:

- The obligation to promote open source initiatives
- Picking a project to support
- Selecting the donation subscription tier for each project's funding
- Keeping track of the financial dependencies

StackAid is a service that addresses this issue. It promises to assist you in simultaneously funding all your project's dependencies. Through its GitHub app (invite-only access), it identifies the direct and indirect dependencies of your project and distributes funds according to your subscription among them. After that, it automates the funding distribution by dividing your subscription money equally among all the dependencies.

It should be noted that StackAid receives the same sum from the subscription fee as a direct dependency in order to make money. However, it takes only up to 7.5 per cent of the entire subscription amount. Installing the StackAid GitHub app enables open source projects to claim their repositories.

Malware creator releases source code of CodeRAT

Following a confrontation with malware analysts, the source code for the 'CodeRAT' remote access trojan (RAT) was posted on GitHub by its creator. A Word document with a Microsoft dynamic data exchange (DDE) exploit was used in the hostile operation, which seemed to come from Iran and targeted Farsi-speaking software developers.

The attack pulls down CodeRAT from the threat actor's GitHub repository and runs it, offering the remote user a wide range of post-infection options. More specifically, CodeRAT comes with extensive monitoring capabilities that target webmail, databases, Microsoft Office documents, social media platforms, integrated development environments (IDEs) for Windows and Android, and even specific websites like PayPal.

Instead of the more typical command and control server infrastructure, CodeRAT uses a Telegram-based method that relies on a public anonymous file upload API to connect with its operator and exfiltrate stolen material. Around 50 commands are supported by the virus, including capturing screenshots, copying content from the clipboard, getting a list of active processes, killing them, checking GPU utilisation, downloading, uploading, deleting files, and running programs.

The attacker can create the commands using a UI tool that creates and obfuscates them, and then sends them to the malware via one of three techniques -- a proxy-based Telegram bot API (no direct requests), manual setting (includes USB option), and commands that are locally stored in the 'myPictures' folder.

The same three techniques, which include focusing on particular file extensions, entire folders, or single files, can also be used to exfiltrate data. If Telegram has been outlawed in the victim's nation, CodeRAT has an anti-filter functionality that creates a different request routing channel in order to get around the restrictions.

Although the malware stopped abruptly when the researchers contacted its developer, CodeRAT may become more prevalent since its source code has been made public.

Rapid Silicon's Raptor Software is a star performer

In the most recent École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL) Combinatorial Benchmark Suite, Rapid Silicon, a provider of AI and intelligent edge focused FPGAs based on open source technology, reported that its commercial open source FPGA EDA suite, Raptor, received 24 verified unique wins and two ties, which is